

brands have grown anywhere between 25 and 40 per cent.

However, there are several categories under which luxury is currently sold in India. The segment that's picking up momentum now in India is the automobile sector. With the entry of players like Porsche, BMW and Audi, the consumption of luxury vehicles will climb to 12,000 units per annum by 2012 from 3100 in 2006. Says Peter Kronschnabl, president BMW India: "The Indian consumer so far has been missing the luxury car experience. So far high net worth individuals bought assets like homes and kept their wealth inside, but now they want to acquire luxury products."

While the super premium and luxury segment worth up to Rs 1 crore is growing, the super luxury segment of cars like Maybach and Bentley are still finding it hard to convert affordability into purchase. Says Satya Prakash Bagla, managing director of Bentley: "India currently has market for 100 super luxury cars in India, which can become 200 in a few years, but that is not to say currently this segment does not exist, it's just about converting it into purchase decision."

Almost every player is rapidly expanding in this market. In order to build on volumes, a brand has to have a national presence and not restrict itself to the metropolitans. Amar Agarwal, managing director of the SPA Group which has brought luxury home and object brands like Ildro and villeroy into India, is planning to open at least 18 to 20 stores. "The market for luxury is still too small to make financial sense, so if we have to be viable we have to have scale, therefore, we need to be in a space which has national appeal."

Whatever be the product, luxury brands are rolling the red carpet for Indian consumers. From personalised shopping offered by Ferragamo to special orders undertaken by Louis Vuitton, they fulfil every whim of the customer and design a product he wants. It's sure to say cheers India! **by Mallini Bhupta**



Samsonite Gold X'Lite
TRAVELLING LIGHT

The lightest, strongest Samsonite ever, the X'Lite is designed to excite even the most worldly traveller with its edgy design. The hugely popular collection is now available in a stunning gold finish and makes the perfect companion for getaways this year. Made of CURV composite material.

PRICE: Rs 35,000 onwards

JIMMY CHOO'S SIGN

LUXURY ON FOOT

The final word for those with a foot fetish, Jimmy Choo is all set to waltz in the country on trendy stilettos. Formed in 1996, the company is today the "it" label for the foot-obsessed and has formed its own cult following. Check out the Sign in pink anthracite nappa mirror and you will know what the beauties of your city are walking... oops talking about.

PRICE: Rs 64,350




Gucci Bluebell Indy **BAGFUL OF BLING**

Guccio Guccio finally comes to India with handbags, watches, shoes, jewellery, sunglasses and ready to wear clothes.

The Indy bag features trademark tassels and graceful beech wood bow handle inspired by the steering wheels of vintage sports cars.

PRICE: Rs 1.58 lakh